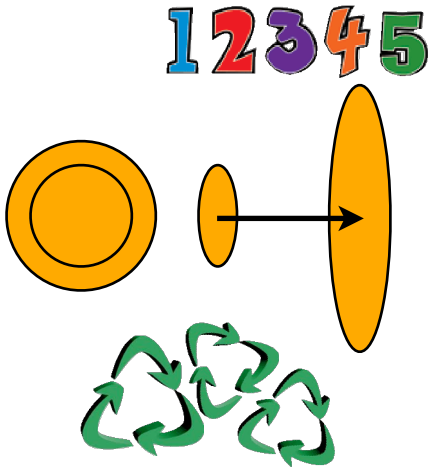
Principles to help determine
Fulfillment of Prophecy

NECESSARY: Inspired prophecy *must come to pass*. [e.g. Jeremiah 39:15-18]

SINGLE: Predictive prophecy has *one fulfillment*; not multiple. [e.g. Acts 2:29-31; Psalm 16]

PREFERABLY NEAR: Choose the *closest* adequate fulfillment.
Note: One still needs to take into consideration that the fulfillment fits the event.



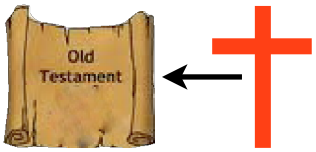
PROGRESSIVE: A progressive prophecy is a series of *successive separate* forecasts (3 or more) strung together. They are in chronological order, but there may be gaps in time between the fulfillment of each successive prophecy. [e.g. Micah 4:9-5:4; Jeremiah 30:4-9]

TELESCOPED: *Contemporary* prophecy (to the prophet) is immediately followed by a *long-range prediction*. [Ezekiel 26; Isaiah 10:28-11:1ff; Mark 13; Zechariah 8]

CYCLICAL: Major *parallel* passages throughout book - poetic reiterations of the same event. Common in apocalyptic literature. [e.g. Daniel 2, 7; Zechariah 9-14; Revelation]

ONE TO ONE: The *NT identifies* the fulfillment of an unfulfilled OT prediction. [e.g. Isaiah 9:1-2 and Matthew 4:15-16; Micah 5:2; Zechariah 9:9 and John 12:15]

NON-LITERAL / SPIRITUAL: Prophecies fulfilled in ways we wouldn't have expected. Often the *NT authors redefine OT concepts* in light of Jesus' work on the cross. Consider the 1st century Jewish expectation of Messiah and his kingdom and how Jesus re-defined what was expected. The NT re-reads the OT with new eyes clarifying how a prediction was fulfilled. [e.g. Amos 9:11-12 – Acts 15:16-17; Malachi 4:5 – Matthew 11:7-15; Hosea 2:23 – Romans 9:25; Joel 2:32 – Romans 10:13]



Jesus is the Goal of Prophecy!

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